

of a button, from food being delivered to our homes to ordering a taxi. I'll take it.

Our money can be automated too, and it's great. It takes away the stress of having one extra thing to do in your life, especially on days when you feel overwhelmed and have so much on your plate already. Sonya, my best friend and podcast co-host, likes to keep money and investing as simple as possible — after all, if it's already a bit of a difficult concept to learn about, we don't want to make it even harder to do.

Once you decide that you want to invest and you have a good understanding of your cash flow, it's time to open an extra online bank account. You want to set up an automation so that every time you get paid, \$X goes into this account. This is your investing account: it's where your investing money sits until you put it into your brokerage account.

For example, say you get paid \$900 every week. After accounting for all your needs and wants and your savings, you have \$50 left.

You'll have \$50 automatically transferred every week into your investing account, and then have the money from there transferred every fortnight or month into your brokerage account to invest.

'Why not invest weekly?' you might ask. Good question.

Many brokers have fees associated, and while we get into fees in a lot more depth in [chapter 5](#), for now let's say that if you're investing with a small amount, like \$50 a week, you're better off saving that and investing \$100 a fortnight or \$200 a month to mitigate the fees. As you can tell, this rule doesn't apply as much if you're investing with a lot more money.

So rather than getting paid, spending what we want and then saving or investing what's left over, we flip the order, putting aside a part of our pay cheque for our future self every time we get paid. It's the definition of paying yourself first. Sonya calls it a form of self-respect and I fully agree. Future you will thank you for it.

Brick #4: Make a rainy day fund

Before we begin investing it's important to have a three-month emergency fund kept in a high-yield savings account. This should cover three months